

SAAS PITCH · JULY 2026

Mail Admin

The Missing UI for Mailcow

A single-panel email management system for agencies who run Mailcow. **25+ domains, 1 login, zero cPanel.**

FOR SKEPTICAL INVESTORS · HONEST ASSESSMENT

01 / 11

THE PROBLEM

Managing client emails is a nightmare of context-switching

Every agency owner knows this dance — and it costs them hours every week.

- ✗ **7 clicks** to create one mailbox in Mailcow admin — do that ×20 clients
- ✗ cPanel license = **\$15–20/month** just for email management
- ✗ Google Workspace = **\$72/user/year** — but client only needs email, not the full suite
- ✗ Adding a new domain means: Cloudflare DNS → Mailcow domain → DKIM → SPF → MX → verify → **30 minutes gone**
- ✗ No unified view: bounce between Cloudflare dashboard, Mailcow admin, SSH terminal, and webmail



The hidden tax: A 20-client agency loses ~8–12 hours/month on email ops. At \$75/hr, that's **\$600–900/month burned** on work that adds zero client value.

02 / 11

MARKET REALITY

The alternatives are all overpriced or overengineered

What agencies actually pay today for email — and what they get for it.

SOLUTION	COST	SETUP	MULTI-DOMAIN	BULK CREATE	INBOX VIEW	SELF-HOSTED
Google Workspace	\$72/user/yr	✖	✓	✖	✓	✖
cPanel + Mailcow	\$15–25/mo	✖	✓	✓	✖	✓
Mailcow Admin (raw)	\$0 (self-host)	✖	✓	✖	✖	✓

SOLUTION	COST	SETUP	MULTI-DOMAIN	BULK CREATE	INBOX VIEW	SELF-HOSTED
Mail Admin	\$0 (self-host)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓



The gap we fill: Raw Mailcow is powerful but has a terrible admin UX for multi-domain management. We add the 20% UI layer that makes it 80% more productive — without the cPanel tax.

03 / 11

THE SOLUTION

A single PHP file that turns Mailcow into a multi-domain powerhouse

One `index.php` deployed on your Mailcow server. No dependencies, no framework, no subscription.

 UNIFIED DASHBOARD

 1-CLICK CREATE

 LIVE INBOX VIEW

All Cloudflare domains auto-listed. Active in Mailcow = blue. Not added yet = gray + one-click add.

Select domain → type local-part → hit create. Auto-sets sender_acl, DKIM-ready attributes, Maildir format. 15 seconds vs 5 minutes in raw Mailcow UI.

Click the inbox icon on any mailbox — see emails in real-time via Doveadm. Client calls asking "did I get that email?" → answer in 2 seconds.

CLOUDFLARE NATIVE

Auto-fetches all zones via CF API. No manual domain entry. 25+ domains, one list, zero config.

SESSION SECURITY

Rate-limited login, HttpOnly+Secure+SameSite cookies, 1-hour session timeout, auto-logout on inactivity.

TOTAL COST

\$0 for the software. Runs on your existing Mailcow VPS. Zero monthly fee. Zero per-user fee. Zero vendor lock-in.

04 / 11

MARKET SIZING

The Mailcow ecosystem is larger than most people realize

Mailcow has 14,000+ GitHub stars and runs on an estimated 50,000+ servers worldwide. Every single one is a potential customer.

50K+

Mailcow instances

Self-hosted mail servers
worldwide — growing with the
privacy movement

~40%

Multi-domain setup

Percentage of Mailcow installs
managing ≥ 3 domains (our TAM)

\$49–149

Price per license

One-time payment, self-hosted.
No ongoing infra cost for us.

\$1.5M+

Addressable Market

20,000 potential buyers $\times$ \$75
average price point



Trend tailwind: Privacy regulations (GDPR, CCPA) + Big Tech email price hikes + self-hosted resurgence = Mailcow adoption accelerating. Every new Mailcow user is a potential Mail Admin buyer.

05 / 11

HONEST ASSESSMENT

**What we have — and what we
still need to build**

Transparency: this is a functional MVP, not a finished product. Here's the honest picture.

✅ **SHIPPED & WORKING**

- Single-password admin login
- Auto-list all Cloudflare domains
- One-click domain add to Mailcow
- Mailbox create (auto sender_acl + DKIM)
- Inbox viewer via Doveadm
- Mailbox delete
- Rate-limited login + session security
- SQL injection protection

🔧 **NEEDED BEFORE SELLING**

- **Multi-user auth** — admin + viewer roles (2-3 days)
- **CSRF protection** — token-based (0.5 day)
- **White-label branding** — logo/name/color config (1 day)
- **Setup wizard** — no base64/SSH (1 day)
- **REST API** — create/delete via API (2 days)
- **Password change UI** — not hardcoded (0.5 day)
- **Favicon + 404 page** (0.5 day)



Estimated build time to sellable product: ~10 days for a single full-stack developer. After that, it's a sellable license.

06 / 11

BUSINESS MODEL

Three-tier licensing with \$0 server cost to us

Self-hosted PHP script = no AWS bill, no container orchestration, no devops overhead. We sell a ZIP file.

Starter

\$49

one-time

Up to 5 domains, 1 admin user. Perfect for freelancers with a handful of clients.

Agency

\$149

one-time

Unlimited domains, up to 5 admin users. For agencies managing 10–50 client domains.

Reseller

\$299

one-time

White-label + custom branding. Resell to your own clients under your brand. Unlimited domains & users.

SaaS (Future)

\$9–49/mo

Optional hosted version. Wait until self-hosted traction validates demand before building this.



Unit economics: At 149/license, *weneed34sales/monthtohit*149/license, *weneed34sales/monthtohit*5K MRR. Zero COGS (customer hosts it). Support via email + docs. 80% gross margin from day one.

07 / 11

FINANCIAL PROJECTION

Conservative 12-month bootstrapped forecast

No outside capital required. This is a lifestyle-business-sized opportunity that can scale.

SCENARIO
Conservative

5 sales/month @ avg \$99

Year 1 Revenue

SCENARIO
Moderate

15 sales/month @ avg \$99

Year 1 Revenue

SCENARIO
Strong

30 sales/month @ avg \$99

Year 1 Revenue

\$6K

\$18K

\$36K

Why we're not projecting millions: This is a niche tool for a niche audience within a niche market. That's a feature, not a bug. The total addressable market is ~20,000 buyers. At \$99 average, that's a **\$2M lifetime ceiling** without expansion — enough for a comfortable solo business or small team, not a VC-backed unicorn. If you're looking for 100x returns, this isn't it. If you're looking for a **capital-efficient, high-margin niche SaaS** that covers lifestyle costs from month one — this works.

08 / 11

COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

No one owns this specific niche — and that's both good and risky

The market is fragmented between expensive enterprise tools and DIY complexity.

COMPETITIVE THREATS

- **Mailcow SOGo UI** — free, but clunky. Requires navigating multiple tabs.
- **cPanel / WHM** — \$15-25/mo. Better UI but expensive for just email.

OUR MOAT

- ☒ **First mover** in Mailcow-specific admin tools
- ☒ **Cloudflare native** — auto-integration no competitor offers

- **Google Workspace reseller** — \$72/user/yr. Too expensive for low-value mailboxes.
- **Mail-in-a-Box** — simple but single-domain. Doesn't scale.
- **Built-in Mailcow API users** — power users script their own solutions.

-  **One PHP file** — zero dependencies, zero deployment friction
-  **Self-hosted** — no data leaves your server (GDPR selling point)
-  **Price** — \$49–149 one-time beats every recurring option



The real risk: Mailcow could improve their admin UI. Or a competitor could fork this and undercut. Our defense: build an active community (GitHub + forum presence) and move fast on feature requests. Speed + niche focus = moat for a product this size.

09 / 11

GO-TO-MARKET

Distribution without a marketing budget

The target audience is concentrated in specific communities. No paid ads needed — just being present.

HOT CHANNEL

r/Mailcow (Reddit) + LowEndTalk — These communities have concentrated Mailcow users actively looking for better admin tools. One well-written post = hundreds of targeted views.

ORGANIC CHANNEL

GitHub repo + Mailcow docs — Publish as open-core (free basic version + paid pro features). Let the GitHub stars bring traffic. Mailcow itself grew this way.

NICHE CHANNEL

Web hosting FB groups + WHMCS communities — Agency owners and hosting resellers with exactly this pain point. One shared post in a 50K-member group = 10-20 leads.

CHANNEL	COST	EFFORT	EXPECTED SALES/MO	TIME TO FIRST SALE
Reddit (r/Mailcow, r/webhosting)	\$0	2 hrs/wk	5-15	1-2 weeks
LowEndTalk forum	\$0	3 hrs/wk	10-20	2-4 weeks
GitHub open-core release	\$0	1 day setup	5-10	1-3 months
Facebook hosting groups	\$0	2 hrs/wk	3-8	2-4 weeks

10 / 11

THE ASK

We're not asking for millions. We're asking for the right thing.

This isn't a VC-scale business — and we're not pretending it is. Here's what we actually need.

What We Need

\$5K

seed funding — OR —

10 beta customers

at \$49 each (pre-launch discount)

What For

- 10 days dev time → sellable v1.0
- Landing page + Gumroad/Lemonsqueezy payment
- Demo video + documentation
- First Reddit/HN post campaign

The honest pitch: This is a niche tool with a \$2M lifetime ceiling. It won't make you 100× on your investment. What it *will* do is generate **cash-positive revenue from month one** with zero burn rate. If you want a capital-efficient micro-SaaS that pays for itself within the first 3 months — this is it. If you're looking for a unicorn — this isn't, and that's okay.



Ready to discuss? We can ship v1.0 in 10 days. First 10 beta customers locked in at \$49. From there, revenue funds everything. No dilution needed — just the right launch push.

